



ST COLMCILLE'S CHURCH, HOLLYWOOD PARISH

Fr Stephen P McBrearty PP

2A My Lady's Mile, Holywood, BT18 9EW Tel: 028 9042 2167 Office Hours: 10.00am – 2.00pmEmail: holywood@downandconnor.orgWebsite: www.stcolmcilleshollywood.org**SEASON OF CREATION****Opening Mass for the Season of Creation 6pm on Sunday 6th September****St. Patrick's Church, Donegall Street, Belfast:**

Celebrant: Fr Piaras Jackson SJ, with interfaith contributions. This Mass marks the beginning of the Season of Creation (1 Sept–4 Oct), a time when Christians worldwide commit to prayer and action for our common home under the theme "Living Water". 1st September is the World Day of Prayer for the Care of Creation. In his message for the occasion, Pope Leo said, "The prophetic call to "beat swords into ploughshares" (*Is* 2:4) is (...) not only a vision for nations, but a call to each person. It invites us to transform harm into life. Yet this transformation cannot be achieved through external change alone. It requires, through cooperating with God's grace, a deeper personal and collective conversion — a returning to God, who will reorder our desires, heal our wounds and help us grow in virtue." Further information on the Season of Creation can be found on our website.

**Lay Bereavement Ministry – Volunteers Needed**

Parishioners are invited to consider becoming

Lay Bereavement Ministers, a new ministry**replacing Bethany Bereavement.** Ministers offer

compassionate support to those who are grieving through visits, telephone contact, group support and parish remembrance events. We are looking for people with good listening and communication skills, a caring and non-judgemental approach, reliability, and an active parish faith. A minimum team of 4 people is required, with ministry carried out in pairs. Teams can also work across a Family of Parishes. **Training: 29 September–14 November** at the Diocesan Offices, 120 Cliftonville Road, Belfast. Attendance at all six sessions is required. **Application deadline: 12 noon, Friday 18 September.** Places are limited. Further information is on our website

www.stcolmcilleshollywood.org**MASS TIMES**

Saturday vigil Mass 6.30pm

Sunday 10am & 12noon

Weekday Mass

Monday at 7.00pm

Tuesday Wednesday &

Thursday at 9.30am

Friday at 7.00pm

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**Tuesday - St Anthony's Novena during the Mass.**  
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**Friday–Novena of Our Lady of Perpetual Succour during Mass.**  
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**Exposition of the Blessed Sacrament for 30 mins before each Mass**  
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Eucharistic Adoration

Every Saturday

12noon – 5.00pm

And before weekday Mass

For 30 Mins

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*Confession is by appointment only – Please contact the parish office for further details*  
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Church Opening Times For Private Prayer

Monday and Friday

Open all day for evening

Mass at 7pm

Tuesday, Wednesday &

Thursday open until 3pm

Saturdays 12noon to 5pm

and Sunday until 1pm.

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**REMEMBERING OUR DEPARTED**

***We pray for those who have died recently and for those whose anniversaries occur around this time.***

**Recently Deceased** Frank Cross Sherry Campbell (Donaghadee), Patricia Higgins, Philip Smith, Fr Michael McConville, Cyril Devins (Dublin), Jim Toner, Rita Loughlin, Paul Clarke. Frances McClay, Eileen Brogan

**Months Mind:** Damien Bintley, Terry Malone, Norman Smith

**Anniversaries:** Daniel Kane, Graham MacManus, Robert Brennan, V Rev Samuel Kerr, V Rev Denis Newberry, Rev Denis McAteer,



# 23<sup>rd</sup> Sunday in Ordinary Time

## Sunday 6<sup>th</sup> September 2026



O God, by whom we are redeemed and receive adoption, look graciously upon your beloved sons and daughters, that those who believe in Christ may receive true freedom and an everlasting inheritance. Through our Lord Jesus Christ, your Son, who lives and reigns with you in the unity of the Holy Spirit, God, for ever and ever.



St Vincent de Paul Helpline Number:  
07845 854671

To donate directly to our bank account, the details are as follows:

**Account Name: Ulster Bank Springhill**

**Account Number: 10523499**

**Sort Code: 98-07-60**

If you would prefer to phone directly to donate money, please phone 028 90750161 and mention Holywood. Thank you for your continued support during these difficult times. If you can, please remember to Gift Aid your donation



**RECHARGE**

### St Colmcille's Ballyhackamore at

7.30pm Join us on the first and third Tuesday every month to recharge your spiritual batteries through prayer, study and friendship. First Tuesday – Adoration with Guided Meditation and Confession. Third Tuesday Group Study Course.

### Beginning Experience – Bereavement Support

Beginning Experience is a peer ministry supporting those who are bereaved, separated or divorced. It is part of the Family Ministry of the Diocese of Down and Connor. The loss of a partner through death, separation or divorce can be devastating. Beginning Experience is offering a programme of bereavement support over three Saturdays:

📅 Saturday 26th September

📅 Saturday 24th October

📅 Saturday 21st November

📍 St Bride's Hall, Derryvolgie Avenue, Belfast

**Booking is essential.**

For further information or to book a place, please contact Marie on 07896 119669 or email

[belfastbe@yahoo.com](mailto:belfastbe@yahoo.com).

*You do not have to walk through loss alone.*

### The Continuous Prayer for Marriage & Family

**Life:** Fr Johnny's prayer intentions for September 2026 can be found in the News & Events section of the website

### Defibrillator Training – Volunteers Needed

Our new defibrillator is located just inside the church entrance, beside the toilets. While it is simple to use without prior training, we are offering short training sessions in September to help parishioners feel confident using it in an emergency.

We still need volunteers from all three weekend Masses to complete the training. No first aid experience is required.

If you would like to take part, please contact the Parish Office with your usual Mass time and contact details thank you.

### St Joseph Men's Camino

*Every Camino changes us in ways we don't expect; every man needs one.* Join men from across Ireland on **Saturday 12th September** for a 25km pilgrimage through the Boyne Valley, beginning in Drogheda. The day includes Mass, Adoration, Rosary, Confessions, fraternity, lunch and dinner, with after-dinner speaker Fr. Mark Quinn. Open to men aged 18+. Cost: €65 (student € 55).

Registration, accommodation and details:

[www.dominicans.ie/events](http://www.dominicans.ie/events). Enquiries:

[op.evangelisation@gmail.com](mailto:op.evangelisation@gmail.com).

### Diocesan Vocations Summer Newsletter

We are delighted to share with you the Diocese of Down and Connor Vocations Summer Newsletter. The newsletter offers an insight into the many ways in which vocations are being nurtured and encouraged across our Diocese, as well as the work taking place to support those discerning God's call. We invite parishioners to take some time to read and reflect on the newsletter and to continue to pray for vocations to the priesthood, religious life and all forms of Christian service. Copies of the Newsletter are on our website

[www.stcolmcillesholywood.com](http://www.stcolmcillesholywood.com)

## DAY RETREAT TO LOUGH DERG

**Saturday 19th September**

Leaving St Paul's at 6.30am Returning to St Paul's at 7.30pm the day includes bus, boat, tea & scones on arrival then a light lunch and retreat. The theme of the retreat is "It is no longer I who live, but Christ who lives in me"

(Galatians 2:20). The morning will include prayer, teaching, fellowship and men's testimonies, with Fr Eddie McGee as keynote speaker.

All men are very welcome. Price for Retreat is £45 plus the bus price determined on the uptake. Telephone St Paul's Parish Office on 028 90325034 Mon – Thurs to book a place.

## Marriage Enrichment Weekend 2nd to 4<sup>th</sup>

**October:** Marriage Encounter Ireland invites married couples to a residential Weekend from Friday 2nd to Sunday 4th October 2026 at the "Focolare Centre" "Curryhills", Prosperous, Co. Kildare. Step away from daily distractions to deepen your communication, renew your love, and rediscover the joy of your marriage.

[www.marriageencounter.ie](http://www.marriageencounter.ie)

## Bereavement Information Evening – Supporting Surviving Siblings

**Tuesday 15 September at 7pm | Online**

Bereaved parents and adult siblings (18+) are warmly invited to join Anam Cara for an evening focused on supporting siblings following the death of a child or sibling.

The event is open to families bereaved at any age, in any circumstances, and regardless of how long ago the bereavement occurred.

Hear from bereavement specialists and local organisations, including LauraLynn, The Student Grief Network, Childhood Cancer Ireland, Jacinta's Smile and Rainbows. Register online at: **Anam Cara Online Bereavement Information Evening**

Please share this event with anyone in your community who may benefit.

For information packs or more about Anam Cara's services: [info@anamcara.ie](mailto:info@anamcara.ie) | 085 288 8888

**Beginning Experience:** The loss of a partner through death, separation or divorce is devastating. Beginning Experience is offering a programme of bereavement support in St Bride's Hall, Derryvolgie Ave., Belfast

**Booking essential.** To find out more, contact Pauline [07519289185](tel:07519289185) or Marie [07896119669](tel:07896119669) or email [belfastbe@yahoo.com](mailto:belfastbe@yahoo.com)



**Thinking about becoming Catholic, or want to deepen your understanding**

**of the faith?** The Diocesan RCIA (Rite of Christian Initiation of Adults) is a journey of faith, formation and community for adults wishing to explore the teachings of Jesus Christ and the Catholic Church. It is open to anyone unbaptised, those baptised in another Christian tradition, or Catholics wishing to reconnect with their faith. The 2026-2027 programme begins on Wednesday 23<sup>rd</sup> Sept and runs weekly from 6.30pm to 8pm in St Mary's Hall Chapel Lane Belfast. Sessions include prayer, teaching, discussion and time for questions. Spouses, fiancés, and friends are also welcome to attend alongside participants. Further details are on our website.



**The Chosen – Season 2 at the Belfast Jesuit Centre:** Weekly screenings of *The Chosen*:

*Season 2* will take place each Friday at the Belfast Jesuit Centre. Tea/coffee at 10.45am, episode at 11.00am, followed by a reflective Examen and discussion. All are welcome; no registration required.

Episode dates: 4 Sept, 11 Sept, 18 Sept, 25 Sept, 2 Oct, 9 Oct, 16 Oct, 23rd October.

Contact: [bjc@jesuit.ie](mailto:bjc@jesuit.ie) | 07955 282371 | [belfastjesuitcentre.co.uk](http://belfastjesuitcentre.co.uk)



**St Vincent de Paul – Treasurer**  
**Could you help us?** We are

looking for a reliable and community-minded person to take on the role of Treasurer for our St Vincent de Paul Group. If you have bookkeeping experience or have previously held a similar position, we would love to hear from you. Your experience would be greatly appreciated and would be a valuable help to our group. If you think you might be interested, or would simply like to find out more, please leave your contact details with Claire in the Parish Office.



**Stay Connected with Our Parish!**

Join the PPC Facebook Page! Want to stay up to date with parish news, events, announcements, photos, and other important information? Follow and like our PPC Facebook page to keep connected with our parish community throughout the week.

👉 Find us on Facebook: St Colmcilles Parish  
Join us online. Stay connected. Be part of our parish community!

## VACANCY – PASTORAL MINISTRY CO-

**ORDINATOR Belfast:** Jesuit Centre, 193–195 Donegall Street, Belfast. The Diocese of Down and Connor is seeking to appoint a Pastoral Ministry Co-ordinator on a 2-year fixed-term contract. The successful applicant will support the Director of the Belfast Jesuit Centre and Chaplain to Ulster University, helping to develop pastoral and spiritual programmes, support volunteers, and create welcoming spaces for students of all faiths and none. Hours: 35 hours per week, including some evening work salary: £29,000 gross per annum Closing date: 12 noon, Thursday 10 September 2026. For the full Role Profile, Employment Application Form and details on how to apply, please visit [www.downandconnor.org](http://www.downandconnor.org) and click Job Vacancies, or visit [www.belfastjesuitcentre.co.uk](http://www.belfastjesuitcentre.co.uk), Community NI or nijob.com. Down and Connor Diocesan Trust is an Equal Opportunities Employer.



## A Year of Ignatian Prayer 2026-2027 Belfast Jesuit Centre

There are a few places remaining on our immersive programme in Ignatian Spirituality, which returns on Saturday 26<sup>th</sup> September; offering ten in-person Saturdays (10am–4pm) in the BJC and seven online Integrative Practice Pause Points to support prayer, discernment and reflective living. Open to those new to Ignatian Spirituality and those seeking to deepen their practice. Suggested donation: £200–£280. Bursaries available. For dates and registration, please visit: <https://belfastjesuitcentre.co.uk/a-year-of-ignatian-prayer-2026-2027/>

## Community Set Dancing Classes in Holywood

are starting again on **Monday 14<sup>th</sup> Sep (7.30pm - 9.00pm)**. Great exercise and good fun. Very different to Riverdance. No need to come with a partner - just comfortable shoes and a friendly disposition! This is an adult class but children over the age of 14 are welcome but need to be accompanied by a parent or guardian. Each class costs £5 (£3 for those under 25). Please call Kevin Mac Mahon on 07940 803839 to reserve a place or for further information

## Abide in His Love Women's Conference.

The Great Northern Hotel, Bundoran,  
**20–22 November 2026.** Join women from across Ireland for a faith-filled weekend with inspiring speakers including Sarah Swafford, Danielle Noonan, Fr Mark Wharton, Fr Barry Braum, Fr Oisín Martin, the Dominican Sisters of Nashville, Bishop Fintan Gavin, and more. A conference not to be missed!

Register now: <https://abideinhislove.eventbrite.com/>

## Lough Derg – August & September 2026

*"A pilgrimage gives us time and space to encounter God more deeply."* — Pope Leo XIV

### One Day Retreats:

5, 6, 9, 12, 15, 19 & 20 September (€50).

### Special themed retreats include

St Peregrine, Pioneer Pilgrimage, St Carlos Acutis, Vocations Monstrance and Divine Mercy:

### Other Events:

20 August: Heritage Day Tours (€15)

30 August: Lakeshore Pilgrim Path Pilgrimage (€25)

### New for 2026:

Overnight accommodation available before retreats and pilgrimages.

Advance booking essential.

Lough Derg, Pettigo, Co. Donegal •

[www.loughderg.org](http://www.loughderg.org) • 00353 71 986 1518



## Requests for Masses for Deceased Relatives and Friends

### In remembrance of loved ones –

To request a Mass for an Intention of a family member or friend. Please give your request either by calling the office 028 90422167 (Option 2) or by sending an email to

[holywood@downandconnor.org](mailto:holywood@downandconnor.org)

Although we cannot guarantee the date you request will be available,

Fr Stephen will be offering

a Mass for the Intention each day



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